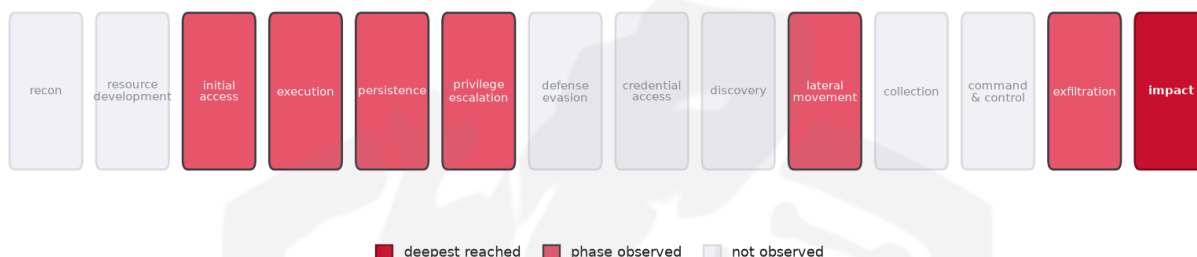


THREAT REPORT: THE GENTLEMEN RANSOMWARE ACTIVITY

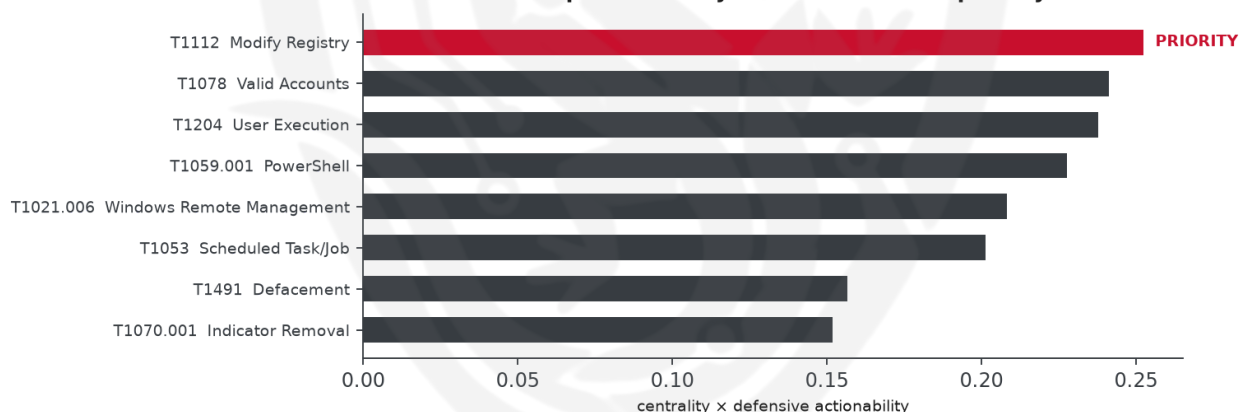
Visual Summary

Kill-Chain Reach — Critical (deepest phase reached: impact)



How far down the attack chain this campaign reached; deepest phase in crimson.

Defensive Chokepoint — why this control is the priority



The control that most disrupts the attack (priority in crimson).

Summary

The Gentlemen ransomware group is observed deploying its eponymous malware without a disclosed CVE exploit. Targeted victims are not identified in the source material, leaving country and sector unknown. The activity leverages a broad set of ATT&CK techniques, with a focus on registry manipulation. Priority should be given to monitoring sensitive registry keys for modification and restricting registry-edit tools for unprivileged users.

Threat Overview

The source attributes this activity to The Gentlemen. The campaign uses the Gentlemen ransomware family. No specific vulnerability (CVE) is cited, and victim details such as country or sector are not provided.

Attack Chain and Priority Control

The observed technique sequence begins with user execution (T1204) to gain initial foothold, followed by persistence mechanisms such as boot or logon autostart execution (T1547) and scheduled tasks (T1053). The adversary then creates or modifies system processes (T1543) and leverages Windows Management Instrumentation (T1047) for lateral movement, complemented by valid accounts (T1078) and Windows Remote Management (T1021.006). Execution is performed via PowerShell (T1059.001) and obfuscated files (T1027), while defense evasion includes indicator removal (T1070.001) and disabling tools (T1562.001). Impact techniques encompass data encryption for impact (T1486) and inhibition of system recovery (T1490).

Priority technique: T1112 Modify Registry

Priority control: Monitor sensitive registry keys for modification; restrict registry-edit tools for unprivileged users.

Infrastructure and Corroboration

Abuse.ch corroborates the presence of the Gentlemen malware family associated with this activity. No hosting providers, ASNs, or high-confidence malicious IP indicators (≥80% AbuseIPDB confidence) were identified in the enrichment data.

Technical Appendix

Ground-truth telemetry from the source pulse; analytical scores are secondary and clearly labelled.

Observed Techniques (ATT&CK, expert-tagged by source)

- T1047 Windows Management Instrumentation
- T1543 Create or Modify System Process
- T1547 Boot or Logon Autostart Execution
- T1489 Service Stop
- T1053 Scheduled Task/Job
- T1567 Exfiltration Over Web Service
- T1112 Modify Registry
- T1491 Defacement
- T1021.006 Windows Remote Management
- T1070.001 Indicator Removal
- T1222 File and Directory Permissions Modification
- T1204 User Execution
- T1059.001 PowerShell
- T1562.001 Impair Defenses: Disable or Modify Tools
- T1078 Valid Accounts
- T1027 Obfuscated Files or Information
- T1486 Data Encrypted for Impact

- T1134 Access Token Manipulation
- T1569.002 Service Execution
- T1490 Inhibit System Recovery

Analytical Scores

- Priority technique (graph chokepoint): T1112 Modify Registry (centrality 0.2658).
- Operational risk: Critical (score 1.0, reaches impact).

Behavioral Signature Cluster

- Method: technique-overlap cosine vs 170 MITRE ATT&CK Groups (top overlap 0.4461; reference threshold $\tau = 0.6$).
- These are behavioural resemblances for defensive playbook cross-referencing, not an identity assessment. Where the source pulse names an actor, that attribution is authoritative; the overlaps below neither confirm nor contest it.

Nearest historical profiles by behavioural overlap (resemblance only):

Historical Profile	Behavioural Overlap
BlackByte	0.4461
Wizard Spider	0.4223
Blue Mockingbird	0.3964
Silence	0.3902
FIN6	0.3639

Enrichment Signal

- Highest AbuseIPDB confidence among IOCs: 0%.
- Malware families corroborated by abuse.ch: Gentlemen.
- Note: enrichment raises the severity signal (an IOC at or above 80% AbuseIPDB confidence, or a confirmed malware-family hit). This is context, not a change to the source assessment.

Indicators of Compromise (defanged — non-clickable)

The network and file indicators observed in this activity are listed below for blocklisting:

Type	Indicator	Context
Hash	30b49ae2f685d4403d3013410f80c2e2	Gentlemen
Hash	68225c5613afe2174ed46e074147676b0f9a3915	

Type	Indicator	Context
Hash	8c87134c1b45e990e9568f0a3899b0076f94be16d3c40fa824ac1e6c6ee892db	Gentlemen
Hash	1ecaf7098bedaa4ffae0ff3e077f937	Gentlemen
Hash	ff709591615a26f037a465ce97cc59d6	Gentlemen

Reputation by AbuseIPDB · malware attribution by abuse.ch · Geo/ASN data by IP2Location LITE.

Flame Cell // Adversary Pivot [BETA]

BETA. A hypothetical tabletop projection, anchored to documented ATT&CK behaviour and technique co-occurrence across 170 tracked groups. It is not a prediction; treat it as a war-game prompt and review before acting. Spot a pivot that looks wrong? norbert@salacti.com

- **Control applied:** T1112 Modify Registry (persistence)
- **Observed here:** T1112 Modify Registry was the only persistence technique observed in this campaign, so the pivot is projected from cross-actor behaviour.
- **Projected pivot:** T1505 Server Software Component (persistence)
- **Basis:** of the 11+ groups that use Modify Registry, this pairing runs 2.0x above base rate, a disproportionately-coupled move rather than the obvious one.

With T1112 Modify Registry blocked, The Gentlemen could preserve the same objective by pivoting to T1505 Server Software Component, a technique disproportionately paired with it across tracked groups. Defensive countermeasure: Integrity-monitor web-server directories for web shells; restrict server module/plugin installation.

Also plausible (same tactic): T1136 Create Account (n=8, lift 2.1), T1197 BITS Jobs (n=3, lift 3.5)

Detection and hardening for the pivot (T1505 Server Software Component)

- **Telemetry:** Web server logs; File integrity monitoring on web roots; EDR
- **Detect:**
 - New/modified files in web-accessible directories (aspx/php/jsp)
 - w3wp.exe / httpd spawning cmd.exe, powershell.exe or whoami
 - Anomalous POSTs to newly created endpoints in web access logs
- **Harden:**
 - File integrity monitoring on web roots; least-privilege service accounts
 - Remove dev tooling from production web servers; WAF in front
- **MITRE:** M1047 Audit, M1018 User Account Management, M1042 Disable or Remove Feature · DS0022 File, DS0009 Process, DS0015 Application Log